

CANDY DIALOGUE ENGINE

Resource Folders Guide

1.1.0

This guide describes how to setup the Candy DE resource folders for your project.

1. Defaults

By default, all resource folders used by Candy DE are located inside the Candy_DE folder.

Scripts

Candy DE's scripts are found in **Candy_DE/Scripts**. The main scripts are located directly in **Candy_DE/Scripts**, while secondary scripts are found in the following subfolders:

UI_Elements:

This subfolder contains scripts for various elements of the dialogue UI (e.g. Dialogue Box or Choice Menus).

Media_Players:

This subfolder contains scripts for media players you might use with Candy DE.

Actor_Nodes:

This subfolder contains scripts for elements parented to actor nodes in your game, rather than to the UI itself, such as the scripts for speech bubbles.

User_Data:

This subfolder contains the **Candy_Database.gd**, **Candy_Properties.gd**, **Candy_Functions.gd** and **Candy_Localizations.gd** scripts. These scripts feature variables and hook functions intended for users to customize as needed.

Scenes

The **Candy_DE/Scenes** folder contains the **Candy_UI.tscn** scene, which is the main dialogue UI, and the **Testing_Scene.tscn** scene, which is used for testing dialogues.

The **Candy_DE/Scenes** folder also contains multiple subfolders for various UI elements, such as **Candy_DE/Scenes/Dialogue Boxes** or **Candy_DE/Scenes/Input Menus**. We won't list them all here, but their names should be explicit enough. Any UI element used by Candy DE should be placed in one such subfolder.

We recommend only storing UI element scenes in those subfolders, not resources for those scenes.

UI Resources

The **Candy_DE/UI Resources** folder contains a few resources used by some of the default UI elements, such as image textures for speech bubbles. You can store your own resources wherever you want, Candy DE and the Candy Dialogue Creator don't access them.

Dialogues

The **Candy_DE/Dialogues** folder is empty by default, but is later used to store the TXT dialogue files exported by Candy DC, where Candy DE can then read them to import their contents.

Media

The **Candy_DE/Media** is where all media is stored. It features two subfolders: Characters and General. The first is for media files pertaining to specific characters, while the second is for general media.

Inside the **Candy_DE/Media/General** folder, media are stored in the following subfolders:

Backgrounds:

As the name implies, this is where files displayed as backgrounds in your game should be stored. The **Backgrounds** subfolder is divided into multiple sub-subfolders:

Animation_Libraries -- Stores Animation Library files, for playing animations on background layers with an AnimationPlayer.

BG, MG, FG, etc. -- These sub-subfolders store the images or videos displayed by background layers. Each layer should have its own folder of the same name (see the **Backgrounds** guide for details).

Images, Sounds, & Videos:

The **Images**, **Sounds** and **Videos** subfolders are used for storing image, audio or video files meant to be played or displayed dynamically by Candy DE in your game.

Each of these subfolders contains multiple sub-subfolders, which correspond to the media players that can be used to display such files.

This isn't very important right now, so see the **Media Control** guide later for details.

The **Candy_DE/Media/Characters** folder contains the following subfolders:

Portraits:

The **Portraits** subfolder contains character portrait files. Each character requires its own sub-subfolder inside the **Portraits** subfolder. For example:

Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Portraits/Alice

Busts:

The **Busts** subfolder contains visual novel-style bust files. Just like with the **Portraits** subfolder, each character requires its own sub-subfolder inside the Busts folder.

Voices:

The **Voices** subfolder contains voice files for spoken lines. Each character also requires its own sub-subfolder inside the **Voices** folder. Furthermore, inside a character's sub-subfolder, voice files are organized by dialogue Conversation and Block, like so:

Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Voices/Alice/Conversation_3/Block_7

This makes it easier to assign voice files to lines in the Candy Dialogue Creator.

2. Custom Folders

The default resource folder structure can be modified if it doesn't suit your own preferences.

IMPORTANT: If you use a custom folder structure, updates will require extra work:

- You won't be able to simply drop the updated Candy_DE folder in your project. You will need to manually place updated files and folders at the custom locations you have chosen.
- If we create patchers (scripts that automatically modify files and folders), they likely won't work with any files or folders not located at their default locations.

Configurations:

First, open **Candy_Properties.gd** and scroll to the "Resource Folders" section:

```
#^ Resource Folders:  
#? The paths to various resource folders Candy DE uses.  
#TODO: Edit folder paths below to fit your own resource folder structure.  
var dialogues_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Dialogues"  
var portraits_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Portraits/"  
var busts_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Busts/"  
var sprite_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Sprites/"  
var voice_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/Characters/Voices/"  
var background_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/General/Backgrounds"  
var image_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/General/Images"  
var video_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/General/Videos"
```

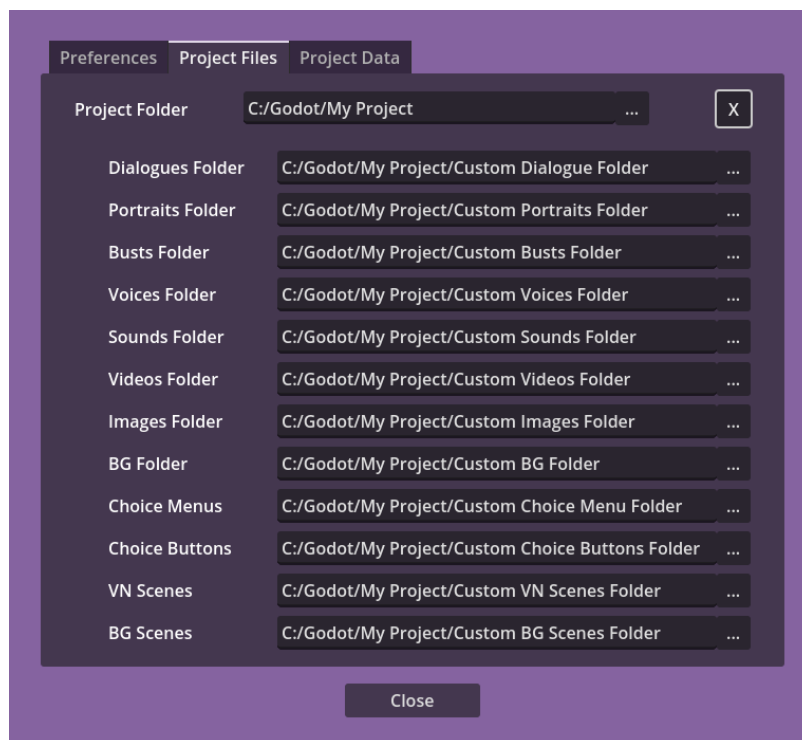
```

var audio_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Media/General/Audio"
var bust_scenes_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Scenes/VN_Scenes"
var bg_scenes_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Scenes/Background_Scenes"
var input_menus_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Scenes/Input_Menus"
var choice_menus_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Scenes/Choice_Menus"
var choice_categories_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Scenes/Choice_Categories"
var choice_buttons_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Scenes/Choice_Buttons"
var export_folder = "res://Candy_DE/Exports"

```

The variables in this section contain paths to the various resource folders that the engine code might refer to, and you will need to update them to point to your own folder paths.

You will also need to enable custom folders in the Candy Dialogue Creator, in the Settings Menu → Project Files tab:



Make sure you have provided the path to your project, then provide the path for each folder from your project's root folder.

Moving folders:

CAUTION: Files and folders should always be moved or renamed only in Godot Editor, through the FileSystem panel.

Scenes

In **Candy_DE/Scenes**, the subfolders that have path variables in **Candy_Properties.gd** can be relocated and renamed as long as the paths are updated. Currently, this includes: VN Scenes, Background Scenes, Choice Menus, Choice Categories, Choice Buttons, and Input Menus.

All other subfolders can be relocated and renamed freely as Candy DE never accesses their contents.

Scripts & UI Resources

Candy_DE/Scripts and **Candy_DE/UI Resources** can be relocated freely: their contents can be relocated anywhere, Candy DE doesn't access these files directly in the resource folders. If you move these folders, you don't need to update any paths in the Candy DE code.

Media/Characters

The folders inside **Candy_DE/Media/Characters** (i.e. **Busts**, **Portraits** and **Voices**) can be relocated and renamed, provided you update their corresponding paths in **Candy_Properties.gd**. The subfolder structure inside these folders, however, cannot be modified -- i.e. characters always require their own subfolder inside **Busts**, **Portraits** or **Voices**, voice files always must be organized by Conversation and Block, etc.

Media/General

The folders inside **Candy_DE/Media/General** (**Backgrounds**, **Images**, **Sounds** and **Videos**) can be relocated and renamed, provided you update their corresponding paths in **Candy_Properties.gd**. The subfolder structure inside these folders cannot be modified.

Dialogues

The **Candy_DE/Dialogues** folder can be relocated and renamed, provided you update its corresponding path in **Candy_Properties.gd**.